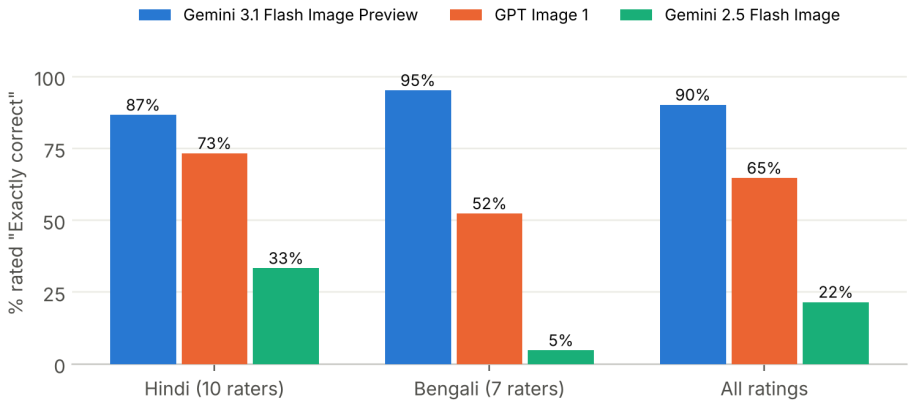
Can AI write a shop poster in Hindi and Bengali?

One-page summary · Swapnil Ghatak · October 2026

What I tested. Whether an image model can make a festive poster a small Indian shop could post straight away, with its message spelt exactly right in Hindi or Bengali. I judged three things, in order: is the text exactly right, would you post it as-is, and which poster is best.

How. Same 6 prompts (3 Hindi, 3 Bengali, from a two-word greeting up to prices, phone numbers and Bengali digits) for Gemini 3.1 Flash Image Preview (Gemini app), Gemini 2.5 Flash Image and GPT Image 1 (both on arena.ai, Direct mode), keeping the first image each time. 11 raters who didn't know which model made what (10 rated Hindi, 7 Bengali, 3 run a business) gave 153 ratings and 51 "best poster" votes. I also checked every poster letter by letter.

#	Model	Company	Text exactly correct (raters)	Text wrong / unreadable (raters)	"Would post as-is"	Picked best overall	Exactly correct (my audit)
1	Gemini 3.1 Flash Image Preview	Google	90%	0%	71%	32/51 (63%)	6/6
2	GPT Image 1	OpenAI	65%	2%	33%	9/51 (18%)	3/6
3	Gemini 2.5 Flash Image	Google	22%	59%	22%	10/51 (20%)	0/6



What I found

- Gemini 3.1 was clearly best: text exactly right 90% of the time, never marked wrong, all 6 correct in my check, and picked best in 63% of votes.
- Bengali is where the others fell apart. GPT Image 1 went from 73% exactly right in Hindi to 52% in Bengali, and Gemini 2.5 from 33% to 5%. Testing only Hindi would have hidden this.
- The mistakes were the ones a shop would care about: a wrong price (₹২৪৯ became ₹২১৭), English digits instead of Bengali ones, and one wrong letter in the word for "special".
- Nobody would post a poster with wrong text, but correct text wasn't enough on its own: GPT Image 1's text was right 65% of the time, yet people would post only 33% of its posters.
- Raters who read only Hindi caught every wrong Hindi poster. Raters who read both scripts let 48% of them through.

Main takeaway. For Indian users, the question "can this model write my language?" has to be answered script by script, by native readers, letter by letter. On that test, only Gemini 3.1 Flash Image Preview is good enough for a shop to use without checking. To scale this up, I'd build a prompt bank for each script, use native raters checked with known-answer posters, add an OCR first pass, and publish a leaderboard per script.